

Document 24: University Transport & Fleet Operations Code

Institution: Hyderabad Institute of Technology (HIT)

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1. Fleet Overview and the "Green Transit" Mandate

The Hyderabad Institute of Technology operates a massive fleet of 60 fully air-conditioned, GPS-tracked buses to provide safe and reliable transit for day-scholar students, faculty, and administrative staff across the twin cities of Hyderabad and Secunderabad. The Department of Fleet Operations (DFO) manages this infrastructure.

In compliance with the university's "Green Transit" mandate, all university buses run exclusively on Compressed Natural Gas (CNG) or electric battery arrays. To minimize the campus carbon footprint, the university heavily restricts private four-wheelers (cars) for students, making the university bus system the primary and preferred mode of transit.

The bus service is an optional facility, not a mandatory requirement. However, once a student opts into the transport system, they are bound by a one-year financial contract. The buses operate on 45 distinct fixed routes. The DFO will not alter, extend, or divert a pre-approved route to accommodate a single student's residential address. Students must board and alight only at the designated nodal stops published on the HIT Transport Portal.

2. Zone-Based Fee Structure and Zero-Proration Policy

The university calculates transport fees based on radial geographical zones extending outward from the main campus gate. The fee is an annual consolidated charge and must be paid in full during the July admission/renewal window alongside the standard tuition fee.

Table 2.1: Annual Radial Zone Fee Structure

Zone Tier	Radial Distance from Campus	Annual Transport Fee (₹)
Zone A	0.0 km to 10.0 km	20,000
Zone B	10.1 km to 20.0 km	32,000
Zone C	20.1 km to 35.0 km	45,000
Zone D	Beyond 35.0 km	55,000

Note: The distance is calculated using the official GIS routing algorithm on the DFO portal, taking the shortest drivable route. Direct straight-line (crow-fly) distances are not accepted for zone calculations.

The Zero-Proration Rule:

The transport fee is strictly non-refundable and non-prorated. If a student decides to join the bus service in the middle of the academic year (e.g., in January for the even semester), they must still pay the full 100% annual fee for their respective zone. Similarly, if a student decides to stop using the bus service in October because they bought a motorcycle, they will not receive any partial refund for the remaining unused months.

3. Digital Boarding Passes and Biometric Verification

Paper bus passes have been entirely abolished. To board any HIT bus, students must utilize the "HIT-Transit" digital boarding pass integrated into the official university mobile application.

Every bus is equipped with a biometric QR scanner at the front door. When boarding, the student must scan the dynamic QR code generated on their mobile app, which refreshes every 30 seconds to prevent screenshots.

- **The "Seat-Lock" System:** The digital pass is route-specific. If a student paid for Route 14 (Secunderabad Station), their QR code will flash red and emit an error beep if they attempt to board the Route 22 bus (Jubilee Hills). Students are strictly prohibited from changing routes without formal approval from the DFO.
- **Temporary Route Change (Guest Pass):** If a student needs to travel on a different route for a single day (e.g., to visit a friend's house for a group project), they can apply for a "Temporary Daily Route Pass" on the app for a flat fee of ₹100 per day. This must be generated at least two hours before departure.

4. Fraud Penalties and Boarding Malpractice

The university treats transport fraud as a severe financial violation. The most common form of fraud is the unauthorized sharing of transport privileges.

If a student who has paid for the bus service attempts to smuggle a non-paying friend onto the bus by letting them scan their ID, handing them their unlocked phone, or distracting the driver, both the paying student and the non-paying student will face severe consequences.

- **Tier 1 Violation (First Catch):** The digital bus pass of the paying student is instantly suspended for 14 days. Both students are fined ₹5,000 each by the Disciplinary Action Committee (DAC).
- **Tier 2 Violation (Second Catch):** The paying student is permanently banned from the transport service without a refund. The non-paying student is suspended from academic classes for one full week.

Furthermore, students are absolutely prohibited from engaging in any physical or verbal altercation with the bus driver or the route coordinator (a designated faculty member riding the bus). If a student demands the driver speed up, stop at an unauthorized location, or uses abusive language, they will face immediate rustication from the university fleet and an automatic DAC hearing for staff harassment.

5. Late-Night Transit and Extended Academic Operations

Standard university buses depart the campus precisely at 4:30 PM. The university recognizes, however, that students participating in sports teams, working in the robotics labs, or studying in the library need safe transit after hours.

To accommodate this, the DFO operates the "Twilight Fleet."

- **Timings:** Twilight buses depart the campus exactly at 7:00 PM and 9:00 PM on standard weekdays.
- **Consolidated Routes:** Because fewer students use the late buses, the 45 standard routes are consolidated into 5 primary arterial routes covering major city hubs. A Twilight bus will not drop a student directly at their home stop; it will drop them at the nearest major intersection.
- **Booking Requirement:** Students holding a valid annual bus pass can ride the Twilight Fleet for free, but they must digitally reserve a seat on the HIT-Transit app before 3:00 PM that same day. If a student attempts to board a Twilight bus without a prior reservation, they will be denied entry, as smaller 20-seater shuttle buses are often deployed to save CNG fuel based on exact reservation counts.

6. Emergency Breakdown and Accident Protocols

If a university bus experiences a mechanical breakdown or is involved in a traffic collision, strict protocols dictate the behavior of the students on board.

In the event of a breakdown, students must remain seated inside the air-conditioned cabin. They are strictly prohibited from disembarking to stand on the highway or walking to catch a public auto-rickshaw. The driver will immediately notify the DFO central dispatch, which will deploy a "Relief Bus" to the exact GPS coordinates within a maximum of 45 minutes.

In the event of a severe collision involving injuries:

1. The driver or route coordinator will trigger the "SOS Protocol," instantly dispatching the campus medical ambulance and local police.
2. Students must utilize the emergency exit windows only if the main hydraulic doors are jammed or if there is a fire hazard.
3. Any student involved in a bus collision is legally mandated to report to the campus medical clinic for a mandatory concussion screening before they are allowed to attend classes the following day, regardless of whether they feel injured or not.